

Personal Website Costing

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Bottom line

The site at chrissenanayake.com costs **\$12 per year**, which is the domain registration. Hosting, storage for all 500 publications, HTTPS and email forwarding are all free.

We are going with a static website on Cloudflare. No database (no Supabase) is needed because the site has no logins or user data. If for some reason we switched to WordPress, the realistic cost is **\$60 to \$100 per year** on cheap shared hosting, rising to \$110 to \$190 once first-year promo pricing ends.

What the site will include

Same structure as the [Baran Lab about page](#), with our own design.

- About: biography, photo, education and positions held
- Awards and honours
- CV as a downloadable PDF
- Publications: all 500 papers, searchable by year and keyword, each linked to the journal and to a PDF where allowed
- Contact: email and links to ORCID, Google Scholar and institutional page

Recommended setup (what we are going with)

A static website: the pages are built once and served as plain files, which is fast, secure and free to host.

Piece	Service	Yearly cost	Free-tier limit and where we sit
Domain	chrissenanayake.com, registrar (already checked)	\$12	n/a
Website hosting	Cloudflare Pages	\$0	Unlimited bandwidth, 20,000 files per site. We need under 100

Piece	Service	Yearly cost	Free-tier limit and where we sit
PDF storage (500 papers, about 1 to 1.5 GB)	Cloudflare R2	\$0	10 GB storage, no download fees, no expiry. We use about 15%
HTTPS, DNS, email forwarding (contact@domain)	Cloudflare	\$0	Included
Editing without code (optional)	Decap CMS or Pages CMS	\$0	Open source, sits on top of the site's GitHub repo
Total		\$12	

Two notes. Cloudflare R2 asks for a card on file even though nothing is billed inside the free tier. If that is a problem, the PDFs can live inside the site itself on Cloudflare Pages at no cost. Traffic is not a concern: a personal academic site gets a few thousand visits a month and none of these limits are close.

The 500 publications

The list is exported once from ORCID or Google Scholar as a BibTeX file, so nobody types 500 entries. The site builds the publications page from that file, with search and filter by year. Adding a new paper means adding one entry.

One point to confirm before uploading PDFs. Publisher PDFs from ACS, Wiley, Elsevier and Nature usually cannot be redistributed on a personal site. The Baran site links to the journal page for most papers for this reason. The safe pattern is to link every paper to its DOI, and host a PDF only for open-access papers and author-accepted manuscripts. Storage-wise, hosting all 500 would still fit for free, so this is a legal question rather than a cost one.

Worst case: WordPress instead

WordPress is itself a content management system. Your boss logs in, edits pages in a Word-like editor and drags PDFs into a media library. No extra tools needed. This is what the Baran site runs on.

The cheapest way to run it with a proper publications list is a shared host such as Hostinger, Namecheap or SiteGround. Hosts sell a low first-year price and renew higher, so both are shown.

Item	First year	From year two
Domain (chrissenanayake.com)	\$12	\$12
Shared hosting with WordPress pre-installed (10 to 100 GB disk, PDFs fit easily)	\$30 to \$60	\$100 to \$180
Theme, publications plugin (TeachPress imports BibTeX), backups plugin	\$0	\$0
Total	\$42 to \$72	\$112 to \$192

The managed alternative, WordPress.com, is \$48 a year on its Personal plan but blocks plugins, so the publications list would be maintained by hand. Plugins unlock on its Business plan at \$300 a year, which is not worth it here.

What WordPress costs beyond money: it needs regular updates to the core, theme and plugins, and unpatched WordPress sites are a common hacking target. It is also slower than a static site. What it buys: your boss or a lab admin can edit everything without any developer involvement.

Side by side

	Static site on Cloudflare (chosen)	WordPress on shared hosting (worst case)
Cost, year one	\$12	\$42 to \$72
Cost, year two onward	\$12	\$112 to \$192
500 PDFs	Free, 10 GB limit	Free, included in hosting disk
Who edits content	Me, or the boss via a free editor add-on	Boss or admin directly, no developer
Maintenance	None	Monthly updates, security patches, backups
Speed and security	Very fast, nothing to hack	Slower, needs patching
Matches the reference site	Same structure, own design	Same structure and same platform

Sources: [Cloudflare Pages pricing](#), [Cloudflare Pages file limits](#), [Cloudflare R2 free tier](#), [Supabase free plan limits](#), [WordPress.com pricing](#), [WordPress hosting costs](#). Shared-hosting figures are approximate ranges across common providers as of September 2026.